

‘Well, *I* was actually the one who told her to round them up,’ I said, sitting on the porch rubbing Buffett’s belly, drinking my third beer.

Betty was unfazed, and trotted off to have a kip under the ute.

Here’s the thing: I wasn’t watching over her shoulder. It didn’t matter. She never gives up.

Betty always gets the job done.

Okay, so you may not be lucky enough to have a broken-down old sheepdog to demonstrate what hard work is for your kids.

But *you* can show them, and you should. It’s up to you to convince your kid that they’ve inherited the hard-work gene. That’s one of the most empowering beliefs you can give to anyone.

It’s something I’ve drilled into my kids from the start. Case in point, the other day my five-year-old said to me:

‘My name is Pape, and you know what that means, doncha Dad?’

‘What does it mean, mate?’ I retorted.

‘It means I’m a hard worker!’

Goosebumps.

Taxi-cab confessions

When your teen begins working, I want you to taxi them back and forth, particularly for the first few weeks.

Yes, even if it means you have to duck off from work early.

Reason being, amazing things happen when your teen is locked in the car and forced to talk to you . . .

You’re going to use this taxi time to become their ‘Work Yoda’.

What’s a Work Yoda?